



Building a Magazine Website by Hacking into Word

Here comes an opportunity to walk through the ideation and development of LinuxForU.com, while seeping in the experience of using WordPress to build a magazine website. We hope, our experience, coupled with LinuxForU.com's source code, helps you tread your own path, and take the Open Source initiative forward.

It was February 2003 when LINUX For You saw its readers' faces for the first time. It's been six years since then, and the only Indian magazine on open source had been struggling and cowering, yet waiting patiently to make its presence felt on the Web. While the domain LinuxForU.com had been a part of our editorial offerings for almost as long, it laid dormant until very recently, when the project was revived all over again with more enthusiasm and determination!

The road to success wasn't a very sweet one, but it was absolutely pleasurable and very thought-provoking. After the debates, cups of tea, innumerable PJs and the intense philosophical discussions, we started looking at *LINUX For You* with a very different outlook. There were a lot of deliberations and immense amount of time spent before we decided on every single aspect of the site, be it the categorisation, the CMS, the colour scheme or a simple CSS styling for the <pre> tag; the experience was immensely educating.

While building a website for a magazine that already has such a huge following with a technical bend, the jitters are never

too far away. That, coupled with the fact that this was practically the very first website for the magazine, and the expectations from co-workers, fans and peers had shot sky-high.

While it was important to make it look good and sexy, our main focus had always been on the features offered by the website. We tried to highlight the Web 2.0 elements of the site, making it more interactive and content oriented.

Coming from a magazine that promotes Free and Open Source Software, it was a welcome surprise when I was asked to write a feature outlining the development of the website. I was also thrilled to know that *LFY* plans to share the source code of the website (minus the database, of course) with its readers. No, we aren't afraid of criticism or rotten tomatoes. Rather, what got us excited was the chance to learn, the scope to improve the site, and the beauty of going open source the true way!

Why do we use CMSs?

Everybody loves Wikipedia, don't they? Well, allow me to quote Wikipedia in my efforts to define what a content management system might be: